

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Joydeep Acharjee

Address: 17 Cornwall Road Cheam SM2 6DU

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I strongly object to application reference DM2025/01591 for the proposed change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub), including extensions and increased building height.

Firstly, this proposal results in the unjustified loss of essential emergency service infrastructure. Ambulance stations form part of critical public service provision and are fundamental to safeguarding community health and safety. The permanent loss of such a facility conflicts with the overarching objectives of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF), which supports the retention and development of accessible community facilities and requires planning decisions to promote healthy and safe communities. There appears to be no clear evidence that the loss of this emergency infrastructure would not harm local service capacity or response times. Once lost, such facilities are extremely difficult to re-provide within the same locality.

Secondly, the proposal raises serious highway safety and congestion concerns. Under the NPPF and local development plan policies, development should not result in severe cumulative transport impacts or compromise highway safety. A place of worship and community hub is likely to generate significant peak-time vehicle movements, particularly during evenings, weekends and event-based gatherings. Dorset Road and surrounding streets are residential, relatively narrow, and already constrained, particularly during school drop-off and pick-up times and periods of high park usage. The increased intensity of use, combined with the proposed extensions and increase in building height, risks overdevelopment of the site and an unacceptable impact on the character and functioning of the area.

The area has limited off-street parking availability, meaning visitors will inevitably rely on on-street parking. This would reduce effective carriageway width, restrict visibility, and potentially obstruct emergency vehicle access. This is especially concerning given the proximity to a school and public park, where pedestrian movements-including children-are high. Planning policy requires safe and suitable access for all users, including pedestrians, cyclists, and disabled persons. Increased congestion and parking pressure would disproportionately impact elderly and mobility-impaired residents, undermining inclusive access principles.

Furthermore, the proposal appears inconsistent with policies that seek to protect existing community and infrastructure uses unless it can be clearly demonstrated that they are no longer required or viable. No compelling justification has been provided to outweigh the public safety and infrastructure concerns associated with the loss of the ambulance station.

For the reasons outlined above - loss of critical emergency infrastructure, unacceptable highway and parking impacts, harm to residential amenity, and conflict with national and local planning policy objectives - I respectfully request that the Council refuse this application in the interests of public safety, accessibility, and sustainable development.